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Security tool integrated into build platform to identify vulnerabilities

Abstract

Techniques for dynamically controlling whether a code build of an application finishes to completion or is terminated prior to completion are disclosed. An application is determined to be entering a development state in which a code build of the application is to occur. After the code build for the application has started, the code build is prevented from completing by a scanning tool. While the code build is being prevented from completing, the scanning tool performs a penetrative test of the application. Based on a result of the penetrative test, the code build is either permitted to complete or, alternatively, the code build is terminated prior to completion.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) Software development (e.g., software development **100** of FIG. **1**) generally refers to the process of designing, programming, debugging, and deploying an application, framework, or other computing construct. Generally, such development follows a process, such as the development

pipeline **200** of FIG. 2. For instance, the development pipeline **200** generally includes a development **205** state in which code is conceived and created by developers. That code is often then committed (e.g., commit **210**) or checked in to a central repository. The checked-in code is then subjected to a code build process (e.g., build **215**) in which executable code is compiled. The executable application is then tested (e.g., test **220**), deployed (e.g., deploy **225**), and staged (e.g., stage **230**). The application is then used in production **235**.

(2) Throughout these different stages, any number of problems can occur. For example, such problems can include security issues. For instance, a bug in the code might unintentionally cause a network port to be opened in the computer when the application is used, thereby potentially exposing the computer to security vulnerabilities. To detect such vulnerabilities, developers often perform a so-called “penetration test” or “pen test” of the application. A penetration test exercises the application in various ways in an attempt to find bugs, errors, security issues, or other aspects of application that could be exploited. Traditionally, penetration testing was performed on a scheduled basis, such as perhaps every month or every quarter.

(3) Interestingly, however, new “roll outs” or “updates” of an application can happen on an almost daily basis. Sometimes, updates can occur multiple times a day. With these updates, there is a potential that new security vulnerabilities will be introduced into the application. If traditional penetration testing techniques were followed, then these security vulnerabilities might be left unchecked for a prolonged period of time, thereby potentially leaving the application and underlying computer subject to exploitation by malicious actors. What is needed, therefore, is an improved methodology for exercising applications to better detect vulnerabilities.

(4) The subject matter claimed herein is not limited to embodiments that solve any disadvantages or that operate only in environments such as those described above. Rather, this background is only provided to illustrate one exemplary technology area where some embodiments described herein may be practiced.

BRIEF SUMMARY

(5) Embodiments disclosed herein relate to systems, devices (e.g., hardware storage devices, wearable devices, etc.), and methods for dynamically controlling whether a code build of an application finishes to completion or is terminated prior to completion.

(6) Some embodiments install (e.g., as a plugin component) a scanning tool into a software development architecture. There is then a determination that an application, which is being hosted in the software development architecture, is entering a development state in which a code build of the application is to occur. After the code build for the application has started, the embodiments prevent the code build from completing. Furthermore, while the code build is being prevented from completing, the embodiments cause the scanning tool to perform a penetrative test of the application. Based on a result of the penetrative test, the code build is either permitted to complete or, alternatively, the code build is terminated prior to completion. The embodiments also generate an alert that includes the result of the penetrative test.

(7) Some embodiments identify that a scanning tool is operating as a plugin component in a software development architecture. The embodiments also determine that an application, which is being hosted in the software development architecture, is entering a development state where a code build of the application executes to generate executable code for the application. After the code build for the application has started, the embodiments prevent the code build from completing generation of the executable code for the application at least until after a penetrative test of the application is performed by the scanning tool. While the code build is being prevented from completing the generation of the executable code for the application, the embodiments cause the scanning tool to perform the penetrative test of the application. Based on a result of the penetrative test, the embodiments either permit the code build to complete the generation of the executable code or, alternatively, terminate the code build prior to completing the generation of the executable code.

(8) Some embodiments determine that an application, which is being hosted in a software development architecture, is entering a development state in which a code build of the application is to occur. After the code build for the application has started, a scanning tool, which is installed as a plugin component in the software development architecture, is used to prevent the code build from finishing a set of build tasks. While the code build is being prevented from finishing the set of build tasks, the scanning tool performs a penetrative test of the application. Based on a result of the penetrative test, the embodiments terminate the code build prior to the set of build tasks finishing. Notably, the result of the penetrative test indicates that the scanning tool has identified at least a threshold number of vulnerabilities for the application.

(9) This Summary is provided to introduce a selection of concepts in a simplified form that are further described below in the Detailed Description. This Summary is not intended to identify key features or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to be used as an aid in determining the scope of the claimed subject matter.

(10) Additional features and advantages will be set forth in the description which follows, and in part will be obvious from the description, or may be learned by the practice of the teachings herein. Features and advantages of the invention may be realized and obtained by means of the instruments and combinations particularly pointed out in the appended claims. Features of the present invention will become more fully apparent from the following description and appended claims, or may be learned by the practice of the invention as set forth hereinafter.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) In order to describe the manner in which the above-recited and other advantages and features can be obtained, a more particular description of the subject matter briefly described above will be rendered by reference to specific embodiments which are illustrated in the appended drawings. Understanding that these drawings depict only typical embodiments and are not therefore to be considered to be limiting in scope, embodiments will be described and explained with additional specificity and detail through the use of the accompanying drawings in which:

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates an example of software development.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a number of stages or steps that can be included in a development pipeline.

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates an example software development environment.

(5) FIG. 4 illustrates how a new scanning tool can be introduced into the development pipeline flow, where this new scanning tool is configured to dynamically control whether a code build process (i.e. a stage in the development pipeline) is permitted to finish to completion or prematurely end.

(6) FIG. 5 illustrates various areas where a penetrative test can probe as well as various issues that can be reviewed as a result of performing the penetrative test.

(7) FIG. 6 illustrates an example architecture in which the scanning tool is used to reveal vulnerabilities.

(8) FIG. 7 illustrates a flowchart of an example method for dynamically controlling whether a code build completes or fails to complete.

(9) FIG. 8 illustrates an example user interface showing various tab features.

(10) FIG. 9 illustrates an example user interface showing an option to connect to a service.

(11) FIG. 10 illustrates an example user interface showing how to connect to source code.

(12) FIG. 11 illustrates an example user interface showing a configuration option.

(13) FIG. 12 illustrates an example user interface showing an option for connecting to a cloud.

(14) FIG. 13 illustrates an example user interface showing various options for connecting to the cloud.

- (15) FIG. 14 illustrates an example user interface having an option to configure certain settings.
- (16) FIG. 15 illustrates an example user interface having an option for specifying deployment options.
- (17) FIG. 16 illustrates an example dashboard that displays various information about an application.
- (18) FIG. 17 illustrates an example dashboard for displaying security practices.
- (19) FIG. 18 illustrates details about a scan.
- (20) FIG. 19 illustrates details about multiple scans.
- (21) FIG. 20 shows another dashboard illustrating details about a security scan.
- (22) FIG. 21 shows various vulnerabilities that have been uncovered or discovered.
- (23) FIG. 22 illustrates an example user interface having a so-called “Red Team” option in which vulnerabilities can be further analyzed.
- (24) FIG. 23 illustrates an example user interface having an option for adjusting a security threshold.
- (25) FIG. 24A shows an option for performing a compliance scan.
- (26) FIG. 24B shows an example user interface for configuring developer settings.
- (27) FIG. 24C shows an example user interface for configuring an image registry.
- (28) FIG. 24D shows another example interface for configuring application images.
- (29) FIG. 24E shows an interface for determining compliance of an application.
- (30) FIG. 24F shows an interface listing various detected vulnerabilities.
- (31) FIG. 25 shows another flowchart of an example method for controlling a build process.
- (32) FIG. 26 shows yet another flowchart of an example method for dynamically controlling a code build.
- (33) FIG. 27 illustrates an example computer system that can be configured to perform any of the disclosed operations.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (34) Embodiments disclosed herein relate to systems, devices (e.g., hardware storage devices, wearable devices, etc.), and methods for dynamically controlling whether a code build of an application finishes to completion or is terminated prior to completion.
- (35) Some embodiments install (e.g., as a plugin component) a scanning tool into a software development architecture. A determination is then made that an application is to be built. After the code build for the application has started, the scanning tool can prevent the code build from completing. The scanning tool then performs a penetrative test of the application. Based on a result of the penetrative test, the scanning tool either permits the code build to complete or, alternatively, the scanning tool terminates the code build prior to completion. The scanning tool can also generate an alert.
- (36) In some embodiments, a scanning tool operates as a plugin component in a software development architecture. An application is determined to be entering a development state where a code build of the application generates executable code for the application. After the code build has started, the code build is prevented from completing generation of the executable code at least until after a penetrative test of the application is performed by the scanning tool. The scanning tool performs the penetrative test of the application. Based on a result of the penetrative test, the code build is either permitted to complete the generation of the executable code or, alternatively, is terminated prior to completing the generation of the executable code.
- (37) In some embodiments, an application enters a development state in which a code build of the application is to occur. After the code build for the application has started, a scanning tool is used to prevent the code build from finishing a set of build tasks. While the code build is being prevented from finishing the set of build tasks, the scanning tool performs a penetrative test of the application. Based on a result of the penetrative test, the embodiments terminate the code build prior to the set of build tasks finishing. Notably, the result of the penetrative test indicates that the

scanning tool has been identified at least a threshold number of vulnerabilities for the application.

Examples of Technical Benefits, Improvements, and Practical Applications

(38) The following section outlines some example improvements and practical applications provided by the disclosed embodiments. It will be appreciated, however, that these are just examples only and that the embodiments are not limited to only these improvements.

(39) The disclosed embodiments bring about significant, real, and practical improvements to the technical field. By way of example and not limitation, the embodiments are able to perform a penetrative test on an application to identify vulnerabilities that an application might have.

Beneficially, this penetrative test is performed during a code build operation of the application.

That is, the embodiments introduce a scanning tool into the software development flow, and that tool can be configured to interrupt the software development flow in a strategic manner. In today's age, new rollouts and updates can occur even multiple times a day. For each update, a new code build occurs. By causing the penetrative test to occur during the code build process, the embodiments beneficially are able to delay the code build in order to check the application for vulnerabilities. If a threshold number or type of vulnerabilities are detected during the time while the code build is happening, then the embodiments are able to terminate the code build before it completes. By doing so, the new rollout or update will be prevented from being pushed out to client devices, thereby ensuring that a compromised application is not released into the public. That is, because this new update was determined to be highly vulnerable, the embodiments beneficially prevent that update from being pushed out, thereby protecting client devices (and the application) from such vulnerabilities.

(40) In this sense, the disclosed embodiments significantly improve computer security.

Furthermore, the act of preventing updates from being dispersed is a real benefit because those updates were determined to be highly susceptible. The embodiments also improve the technical field by providing an intuitive set of user interfaces that are designed to help users understand which vulnerabilities are critical and warrant review right away. Through use of the disclosed user interfaces, the user's interaction with a computer system is also significantly improved.

(41) The embodiments also improve the technical field by providing the ability to sift through different “noisy” security issues. For instance, it may be the case that an application has a large number of vulnerabilities, some of which are more critical than others. The disclosed embodiments are able to collect and analyze the information related to these vulnerabilities and then ranked those vulnerabilities. The embodiments can then present a ranked list and facilitate the triage of the most critical vulnerabilities. Therefore, although one of the biggest problems in the industry is sorting through signal and noise in terms of security issues, the embodiments improve this process by providing a ranked list to users, where the issues raised in that ranked list can be normalized in order to determine their respective severities.

(42) Additionally, as will be discussed in more detail later, the embodiments can discern or determine whether an application is compliant with any number of defined regulations. The embodiments can also detect when executing applications are subject to fast brute force attacks and/or low and slow attacks. By performing the disclosed operations, the embodiments identify security problems before an application is deployed to the public. In effect, the embodiments build in a “hacker” mentality into the software development pipeline, where such a mentality significantly improves the safety of an application. It is axiomatic that resolving problems earlier on in the development process is orders of magnitude easier than resolving problems later on in the development process. By conducting a penetrative test prior to the release of a built application, vulnerabilities can be detected early on in the process and thus can also be resolved earlier.

Accordingly, these and numerous other benefits will now be described in more detail throughout the remaining portion of this disclosure.

Software Development Architecture

(43) Attention will now be directed to FIG. 3, which illustrates a software development architecture

300 in which a number of developers are actively working on developing code for an application. In this scenario, there are four different developers working on four different devices, as shown by developer device **305**, developer device **310**, developer device **315**, and developer device **320**. Each developer at his/her respective developer device is working on code to program an application. The code and supporting files can be “checked in” to a central repository **325** in order to maintain version control and in order to have the code stored and protected in a central location.

(44) Here, the developer device **305** is communicating with the central repository **325** via a network **330**, such as perhaps the Internet or some other network. Similarly, the developer device **310** is communicating with the central repository **325** via the network **335**. In contrast, the developer device **315** and the developer device **320** can have a direct linkage, such as perhaps via a local area network (LAN) with the central repository. Regardless of how the various devices connect and communicate with the central repository **325**, those devices are able to store source code **340** and other files (e.g., libraries, supporting files, executables, etc.) in the central repository **325**. That is, the various files can be checked in **345** and maintained at the central repository **325**. This architecture safeguards the various files (e.g., the source code **340**, libraries, dependencies, supporting files, etc.) from potential loss or even from misuse.

Scanning Tool that can Prevent Build Completion

(45) FIG. 4 shows a development pipeline **400**, which is somewhat similar to the development pipeline **200** of FIG. 2. For instance, the development pipeline **400** includes various stages that can be followed when developing an application **405** in a software development architecture **410**, which can optionally include the software development architecture **300** of FIG. 3 and/or platforms such as an integrated development environment (IDE), a cloud development platform (e.g., IaaS, PaaS, and/or SaaS), or any other platform. The source code **415** of the application **405** can be developed by generally following the development states or stages outlined in FIG. 4 (e.g., commit, build, test, etc.).

(46) One of the stages or states in the development pipeline **400** is particularly emphasized and is labeled as development state **420**. This development state **420** refers to a code build **425** process in which the source code **415** is compiled, and executable code is generated for the application **405**. Generally, the code build **425** process involves a set of tasks (e.g., as shown by build tasks **430**) that operate to create the executable code **435** for the application **405**. As an example, the set of tasks can include fetching the source code from a central repository (e.g., central repository **325** of FIG. 3); compiling the high-level source code into object code or machine language that is executable by a computer system; linking libraries and other files; and even archiving build logs. Of course, the set of build tasks **430** can include other operations as well.

(47) In accordance with the disclosed principles, the embodiments are able to inject or install a scanning tool **440** into the software development architecture **410** as a plug in component **445**. This scanning tool **440** is triggered at least when the build development state **420** is activated, and the scanning tool **440** performs a penetration test **455** and other monitoring operations on the application **405** and optionally even the software development architecture **410** (e.g., perhaps the cloud structure, IaaS structure, PaaS structure, SaaS structure), and/or any other corresponding infrastructure. Additionally, and very beneficially, the scanning tool **440** actively prevents (e.g., as shown by prevent **450**) the code build **425** from finishing to completion until the penetration test **455** is completed and optionally until results of the penetration test **455** are reviewed and analyzed. As will be discussed in more detail later, if the results of the penetration test **455** indicate that the application **405** has serious vulnerabilities (or a threshold number of vulnerabilities), then the scanning tool **440** will terminate **460** the code build **425** prior to completion such that the executable code **435** is not generated and such that the roll out or deployment of the application **405** is prevented from happening. One option for terminating the code build **425** is to throw an error into the code build **425** process. Another option is to simply terminate any tasks or routines associated with the code build **425**, thereby ending the entire process.

(48) On the other hand, if the results of the penetration test **455** indicate that the application **405** does not have serious vulnerabilities (or does not have at least a threshold number of vulnerabilities, as will be discussed in more detail later), then the scanning tool **440** will permit **465** the code build **425** to finish to completion. The scanning tool **440** can also generate an alert **470** that lists or reflects the results of the penetration test **455**.

Penetration Testing

(49) A penetration test is also often referred to as a “pen test.” This test is designed to simulate or mimic a cyber-attack against the application in an effort to identify and exploit vulnerabilities. FIG. **5** shows some additional details of a penetration test, which is reflective of the penetration test **455** of FIG. **4** and which can be included as a part of a security scan **500** (i.e. the security scan **500** includes any type of penetration test). Generally, the security scan **500** can exercise or test source code **505** of an application, the software development architecture **510** of the application (e.g., including the cloud infrastructure, such as the IaaS, PaaS, or SaaS environment of the application), port scanning, OS identification, route tracing, password and username cracking, design errors, configuration errors, software bugs, and so on.

(50) The security scan **500** can also be used to perform a vulnerability assessment to identify security features **515** that are subject to attack or might be compromised as well as other vulnerabilities **520**. In some cases, the vulnerabilities **520** can be ranked **520A** based on priority and/or severity **520B**. The security scan **500** can also determine whether the application, including its constituent parts, follows predefined regulations **525**. Again, further details on all of these features will be provided later.

Scanning Tool

(51) FIG. **6** shows an example architecture **600** in which a scanning tool **605**, which is representative of the scanning tool **440** in FIG. **4**, is configured to scan an application and associated components or infrastructures to detect vulnerabilities associated with that application. In particular, the scanning tool **605** can be a plugin component installed in a cloud environment **610**. The scanning tool **605** can be used in any type of IaaS **615** environment, PaaS **620** environment, or SaaS **625** environment. Not only can the scanning tool **605** analyze an application, but it can also analyze the underlying infrastructure, such as the IaaS **615** environment, the PaaS **620** environment, and/or the SaaS **625** environment. Additionally, the scanning tool **605** (e.g., scanning layer) can occur externally and/or internally. For instance, the scanning tool **605** can be implemented externally relative to an application, and the tool can probe the application in a manner similar to an external hacker would follow. When external to the application, the tool might not have access to the underlying source code and other files. When internal relative to the application, the tool has access to the application's files.

(52) The scanning tool **605** is provided read-only access **630** to a central repository that stores application related data. With this read-only access **630**, the scanning tool **605** can perform a pen test or scan **635** on files **640**, databases **645**, or even infrastructure **650** associated with an application. The ellipsis **655** demonstrates how the scanning tool **605** can scan and analyze any other construct as well, without limit.

(53) In some cases, the scanning tool **605** can use machine learning **660** to facilitate the scan **635** and even to analyze the results of the scan **635**. Any type of ML algorithm, model, machine learning, or neural network may be used to facilitate operations associated with the scan **635**.

(54) As used herein, reference to “machine learning” or to a ML model or to a “neural network” may include any type of machine learning algorithm or device, neural network (e.g., convolutional neural network(s), multilayer neural network(s), recursive neural network(s), deep neural network(s), dynamic neural network(s), etc.), decision tree model(s) (e.g., decision trees, random forests, and gradient boosted trees), linear regression model(s) or logistic regression model(s), support vector machine(s) (“SVM”), artificial intelligence device(s), or any other type of intelligent computing system. Any amount of training data may be used (and perhaps later refined) to train the

machine learning algorithm to dynamically perform the disclosed operations.

(55) The scanning tool **605** is also able to access or query a public database **665**, which may be located remotely from the scanning tool **605**. The public database **665** can include a listing of known threats **670**, such as spyware, malware, trojans, viruses, ransomware, and so forth. By consulting the public database **665**, the scanning tool **605** can determine whether the application would be subject to any of those known threats **670**.

(56) As will be discussed in more detail later, a user interface UI **675** can also be provided for the scanning tool **605** to enable users to configure the scanning tool **605** and to interact with the results **680** generated by the scanning tool **605**. For instance, the UI **675** can display a list of vulnerabilities **680A** that the application is likely subject to, based on the scan **635** performed by the scanning tool **605**, where the vulnerabilities **680A** are included as a part of the results **680**.

(57) When the scanning tool **605** is applied to a new application, then the scanning tool **605** can complete a full scan of the application's entire contents and associated components, to thereby generate an initial baseline scan of the application. During subsequent scans of an application, however, the scanning tool **605** can scan and analyze only the changes or deltas (e.g., as shown by delta **685**) between the initial version or subsequent version and the immediate version of the application. By analyzing only the deltas, the scanning tool **605** can significantly speed up the scanning process.

(58) If the scanning tool **605** identifies potential vulnerabilities in the application, then the scanning tool **605** can surface an alert **690**, potentially in the UI **675**, to inform the user of the vulnerabilities. This alert **690** can list the vulnerabilities as well as their levels of severity. Further details on such alerts will be provided later in some of the subsequent figures.

(59) Even after an application is deployed, the scanning tool **605** can still be used to analyze and even protect an application. For instance, the scanning tool **605** can monitor the application as well as traffic flowing to and from the application. In doing so, the scanning tool **605** can detect when the application is being attacked (e.g., as shown by attack **695**), such as by a denial of service attack, which is a type of fast brute-force attack.

(60) The scanning tool **605** can detect other types of attacks as well, such as malware attacks, ransomware attacks, and so on. In addition to fast or "brute-force" attacks, the scanning tool **605** can also detect when low and slow attacks are occurring.

(61) A slow attack is a type of attack in which a small stream of traffic is targeting an application. Such attacks can be difficult to detect. The scanning tool **605** is able to analyze a data packet's fingerprint **695A** to determine where the packet originates and/or through which computing devices the packet has passed through.

(62) By consulting the public database **665**, the scanning tool **605** can discern, based on the fingerprint **695A**, whether the application is subject to a fast brute-force attack or a low and slow attack. Notably, the fingerprint **695A** can include various identifying information, such as which devices (e.g., routers, switches, computers, etc.) were used to transmit a particular data packet. The fingerprint **695A** can be inspected without necessarily inspecting the contents of the data packet.

Example Methods

(63) The following discussion now refers to a number of methods and method acts that may be performed. Although the method acts may be discussed in a certain order or illustrated in a flow chart as occurring in a particular order, no particular ordering is required unless specifically stated, or required because an act is dependent on another act being completed prior to the act being performed.

(64) Attention will now be directed to FIG. 7, which illustrates a flowchart of an example method **700** for dynamically controlling whether a code build of an application finishes to completion or is terminated prior to completion. Method **700** can be implemented in the architecture **600** of FIG. 6 by the scanning tool **605**.

(65) Initially, method **700** includes an act (act **705**) of determining that an application (e.g.,

application **405** of FIG. **4**), which is being hosted in a software development architecture (e.g., software development architecture **410**), is entering a development state (e.g., development state **420**) in which a code build (e.g., code build **425**) of the application is to occur.

(66) In some cases, the process of determining that the application is entering the code build development state can be performed by the scanning tool interacting with the computer system's operating system (OS) to determine what state the application is currently in and what state the application is transitioning to. In some cases, the scanning tool can also intercept inter-application communications to identify that application's state. In some cases, the scanning tool can identify when a build tool or compilation tool is launched, which tool is then used to facilitate the code build process. Accordingly, there are numerous different techniques to determine when the code build process will occur, and the scanning tool can perform the operation of determining that the application is entering the development state. In some cases, the scanning tool is launched or triggered when the application enters the build state. For instance, a library or software development kit (SDK) can be installed as a part of the infrastructure, and that library can follow policy indicating that the scanning tool is to be initialized or launched once the application enters the build state.

(67) After the code build for the application has started, there is an act (act **710**) of using a scanning tool (e.g., scanning tool **605** of FIG. **6**) installed as a plugin component in the software development architecture to prevent the code build from finishing a set of build tasks (e.g., build tasks **430** of FIG. **4**). The process of preventing the code build from finishing can include interjecting a delay command into the build process to prevent the code build from completing. The prevention process can also include pausing the code build using any other techniques available to pause a routine. Although the above description indicated that the scan can occur after the build starts, it should be noted that other scans can occur at other times as well. For instance, a scan can occur in response to code being checked in or committed as well.

(68) While the code build is being prevented from finishing the set of build tasks, act **715** involves causing the scanning tool to perform a penetrative test (e.g., security scan **500** of FIG. **5**) of the application. With this penetrative test, the scanning tool exercises the application in numerous different ways in an attempt to identify vulnerabilities that the application might have. The penetrative test can also optionally include scanning the underlying infrastructure in which the application is being developed, such as whatever cloud platform is hosting the application.

(69) Based on a result of the penetrative test, there is an act (act **720**) of terminating the code build prior to the set of build tasks finishing, such as when the results indicate certain vulnerabilities. Notably, the result of the penetrative test indicates that the scanning tool has identified at least a threshold number of vulnerabilities for the application. The threshold number can be adjustable. If the number of vulnerabilities meets or exceeds the threshold, then the scanning tool terminates the code build. In some cases, terminating the code build is performed by throwing an error such that the code build ends. In some cases, terminating the code build is performed by ending tasks associated with the code build. In some cases, the termination process is performed by the scanning tool instructing the OS to end the code build and/or instructing some other component to end the code build.

(70) In some implementations, the set of build tasks includes pushing an update to a client device. Here, the code build can optionally be terminated prior to pushing that update to the client device.

(71) In some cases, one or some of the vulnerabilities that were detected as a result of performing the pen test can be resolved by the disclosed embodiments. For instance, a number of mitigation operations can be performed in an attempt to fix or resolve the vulnerabilities. Such mitigation operations can include closing ports that might be open on a device, establishing a firewall, alerting an administrator, or perhaps even terminating a network connection. Mitigation operations can also be performed when attacks against the application or computer are detected.

(72) In some implementations, the code build is allowed to complete, such as when the number of

detected vulnerabilities does not exceed a threshold. Therefore, in some cases, the set of build tasks can be performed and the new update or application can be pushed out to the public.

Example User Interfaces and Processes

(73) Attention will now be directed to FIGS. **8** through **24F**. These figures illustrate various user interfaces that can be displayed on a device and that can display operations associated with the scanning tool **605** of FIG. **6**. As an example, these various user interfaces can represent the UI **675** of FIG. **6**. Furthermore, these various user interfaces can display the results **680**.

(74) FIG. **8** shows an initial user interface **800** that is available when a user first logs into the scanning tool application. Here, there are a number of tabs, such as tab **805**, tab **810**, and tab **815**. These are for example purposes only, and more or less tabs can be used. Tab **805** refers to a “Managed Services” option; tab **810** refers to a “Scans” option; and tab **815** refers to a “Red Teaming” option. The features associated with each tab will be discussed in detail.

(75) FIG. **9** shows a resulting user interface **900** that is displayed in response to selecting the tab **805** (i.e. “Managed Services”). User interface **900** is designed to help a user connect to a new service, as shown by connect to service **905**. In this context, the “service” is one that is to be reviewed and analyzed by the scanning tool, such as the application **405** of FIG. **4**.

(76) Here, the user can enter the organization name of the service (e.g., “SafeOps Demo”) as well as the service's name (e.g., “frontend”). User interface **900** shows the first step (e.g., “New Service”) of a six part step, as indicated by the flowchart near the top of the user interface **900** (e.g., step 1 is “New Service;” step 2 is “Connect Source Code;” step 3 is “Cloud Provider;” step 4 is “Configure;” step 5 is “Review;” and step 6 is “Security Practices”).

(77) FIG. **10** shows step 2 (e.g., “Connect Source Code”) of the six part process. Here, the user is able to connect his/her source code to the scanning tool, as shown by connect source code **1000**. As discussed previously, the source code is stored in a central repository, such as central repository **325** of FIG. **3**. Optionally, that central repository can be GitHub™, BitBucket™, or any other source code repository. Indeed, the scanning tool is able to connect to any type of repository, without limit.

(78) In this example process, the user has indicated that his/her code is stored in a GitHub' repository. FIG. **11** shows a configuration **1100** option for enabling the scanning tool to have read-only access to that repository. Of course, the principles should be construed broadly in that the user interface can be customized to accommodate the configuration for any type of repository. In FIG. **11**, the user interface (and hence the scanning tool) is acquiring additional information regarding the configuration settings of the repository so that the scanning tool has adequate permissions to access and analyze the service's, or rather the application's, source code and associated files in order to detect vulnerabilities.

(79) FIG. **12** shows options for the third step (e.g., “Cloud Provider”). Specifically, FIG. **12** shows options to enter cloud details **1200** of whatever cloud platform the user is using to host and/or develop his/her application. The scanning tool is able to connect to any cloud provider. Examples of cloud providers include, but certainly are not limited to, Amazon AWS™, Microsoft Azure™, Google Cloud Platform™, VMWare™, and so on without limit. Using the interface shown in FIG. **12**, the user can enter configuration details to enable the scanning tool to obtain access (read-only) to the cloud platform hosting his/her application. FIG. **13** shows additional options for entering cloud details **1300**.

(80) FIG. **14** shows step four (e.g., “Configure”), where the user can enter configuration **1400** details regarding how his/her application is orchestrated. In this example case, the user can select Kubernetes™ or AWS ECS™. Of course, other options can be made available.

(81) FIG. **15** includes options for receiving input regarding the deployment **1500** application the user uses. Here, four different options are listed, but one will appreciate how any number can be provided.

(82) FIG. **16** shows a dashboard **1600** that facilitates the fifth step (e.g., “Review”). With the

dashboard **1600**, the user can enter additional details about his/her application, such as a URL that can be used to connect to the application, username and password details, environment details, and further repository details. FIG. **17** then shows details for the sixth step (e.g., “Security Practices”). This interface allows the user to enter security **1700** information, such as firewall details, intrusion detection system details, and so on.

(83) After the initial configuration, the scanning tool now has adequate permissions to scan the service/application. Accordingly, using the principles discussed previously, the scanning tool scans the service in an attempt to identify vulnerabilities. This scanning process is triggered when the application is subject to a code build process.

(84) FIG. **18** shows various scan details **1800**, which include details on current and previous scans that have been performed for the user's application. Here, the scan details **1800** list the number of vulnerabilities that were detected, when the last scan was performed, details about a build status, details about a cloud scan, details about an application/service scan, and details about a repository scan. With the interface shown in FIG. **18**, a user can readily see the status of his/her scans and vulnerabilities.

(85) FIG. **19** shows the resulting interface when a user selects the tab **810** in FIG. **8** (i.e. the “Scans” tab). Here, the interface provides details regarding scan **1900**. Notice, the scans **1900** include an application scan, a cloud scan, an image scan, a Kubernetes™ scan, and a repository scan. The interface also displays the status of those scans (e.g., running, pending, etc.), when those scans were last run, a blackout time (e.g., a time when the corresponding component is down and not available for use by the public), and an option for adjusting settings for those scans.

(86) FIG. **20** shows an interface configured to display additional security details **2000**. For instance, the scanning tool is able to scan and analyze an application and then generate a “Security Score.” This score, which can be normalized for use across any number or type of applications, can be a score that generally reflects how secure the application is, based on the detected vulnerabilities. The security details **2000** can list a summary view of the various vulnerabilities, including unknown or unprecedented potential vulnerabilities, informational details, minor vulnerabilities, major vulnerabilities, and critical vulnerabilities. In this sense, the scanning tool is able to rank and prioritize its findings or results. In some cases, machine learning can be used to generate the score based on the findings or results of the scan.

(87) In some cases, the machine learning can be used to rank the various vulnerabilities into respective severity categories. The machine learning can perform this ranking by predicting how much of an impact the exploitation of a particular vulnerability would have against a computer or the application. For instance, the machine learning can predict that exploiting a particular vulnerability might enable a hacker to crash the computer or application while in another case exploiting a particular vulnerability might simply slow down a computer. Indeed, the machine learning can make various predictions regarding the impact or consequence that a particular vulnerability might have.

(88) FIG. **21** shows an interface that provides additional details regarding the vulnerabilities **2100** detected by the scanning tool. Such details can include a title of the vulnerability, a severity, a category, the test used to detect the vulnerability, where the vulnerability is located, and additional comments or details on the vulnerability.

(89) The vulnerabilities can be reviewed as a part of a so-called “Red Teaming” operation. This review can be performed automatically by a machine learning component or, alternatively, the review can be conducted by a team of trained computer experts who are trained to identify vulnerabilities and then attempt to exploit those vulnerabilities (i.e. hackers). The team attempts to exploit those vulnerabilities in a controlled setting in order to inform the user or owner of the application how his/her application is likely to be attacked. The disclosed embodiments also provide enhanced education and training to enable users to know and understand what security threats their applications may face. In this sense, the embodiments and disclosed tools provide a

knowledge base for identifying, understanding, and even potentially resolving security issues.

(90) Optionally, the team can also attempt to devise solutions that would cure the vulnerability. In some cases, a single solution might fix or resolve multiple vulnerabilities. In some cases, the Red Teaming organization can attempt to hack the application in other ways that potentially were not identified by the vulnerabilities.

(91) With the “Red Teaming” option, an instance of the application can be reserved for a period of time or a window of reserved time. Additionally, or alternatively, the application can be taken offline for a planned outage. In any event, the application can be reserved for a period of time. During that time, the Red Teaming group (e.g., human users and/or machine learning) can attempt to exploit or exercise the application in an effort to identify weaknesses or vulnerabilities. Once these vulnerabilities are identified, then the Red Teaming group can propose fixes on how to resolve those vulnerabilities. The user interface can display the notes and solutions, as shown by red team **2200** in FIG. **22**.

(92) As discussed previously, the disclosed embodiments are able to allow a code build process to complete or, alternatively, can disrupt the code build process such that it fails to complete. In some cases, the embodiments disrupt the code build process when a threshold number of vulnerabilities are detected and/or when certain types of vulnerabilities are detected. FIG. **23** is illustrative.

(93) FIG. **23** shows an interface that allows a user to adjust various settings **2300**. Specifically, the interface in FIG. **23** shows a threshold **2305** option that can be adjusted. When the scanning tool detects a number of vulnerabilities that meet or exceed the threshold **2305** (e.g., in this case the threshold **2305** is set to a value of “80”), then the code build process will be disrupted and the code build will be prevented from completing.

(94) Additionally, FIG. **23** shows another threshold listing a “Max Critical Issues,” which is currently set to a value of “5.” That is, the scanning tool is able to rank vulnerabilities based on a level of severity. Some vulnerabilities can be classified or ranked as being “Critical” (i.e. these should be resolved immediately), some can be ranked as “Major” (i.e. these should be resolved within a short time period but are not as high priority as the “Critical”), and some can be ranked as “Minor” (i.e. these should be resolved at some time in the future). Of course, other labels can be used.

(95) Here, if the number of vulnerabilities ranked as being “Critical” exceed the “Max Critical Issues,” then the scanning tool will terminate the code build process, even if the threshold **2305** has not yet been reached. In this sense, the “Max Critical Issues” threshold has a higher priority over the threshold **2305** and can terminate the code build independently of the threshold **2305**.

(96) FIG. **24A** shows an interface that allows a user to impose various compliance **2400** requirements, or rather, to determine whether an application complies with the compliance **2400** requirements. To illustrate, the interface lists a number of different regulations **2405**, such as HIPAA, PCI, CIS level 1, and CIS level 2 regulations. By selecting any one or more of the regulations **2405**, the scanning tool can analyze the underlying application, including source code, to determine whether that application complies with the selected regulations **2405**. If the application complies, then the scanning tool can generate an alert reflecting the compliance. On the other hand, if the application does not comply, then the scanning tool can generate an alert reflecting how and where the application does not comply. The scanning tool can also analyze the underlying infrastructure (e.g., cloud platform, deployment platform, orchestrate platform, etc.) to determine whether that infrastructure is or is not in compliance as well.

(97) FIG. **24B** shows a set of developer settings **2410** that are modifiable by the user. For instance, FIG. **24B** shows how a user can enter and edit various API keys in order to enable applications to interact with one another.

(98) FIG. **24C** shows an example configuration **2415** user interface that allows the user to enter image registry information. For instance, the disclosed tools can receive information about an application's registry credentials in order to access an application's image. Relatedly, FIG. **24D**

shows an example configuration **2420** user interface that can be used to obtain additional information regarding locations where an application's image or images are stored.

(99) FIG. **24E** shows a compliance **2425** user interface that shows, based on results of the scanning operations, whether an application is in compliance with various compliance requirements, as discussed previously. The compliance **2425** interface can provide a percentage indicator to reflect a level of compliance the application has with certain standards or regulations (e.g., 80% compliance).

(100) FIG. **24F** shows a vulnerabilities **2430** user interface that lists identified vulnerabilities an application might have, as identified by the scanning tool. Status or severity indicators can be displayed next to each vulnerability that is identified.

Additional Example Methods

(101) FIG. **25** shows a flowchart of an example method **2500** for dynamically controlling whether a code build of an application finishes to completion or is terminated prior to completion. Method **25** can be performed using any of the architectures mentioned herein as well as any of the user interfaces mentioned herein.

(102) Initially, method **2500** includes an act (act **2505**) of installing, as a plugin component, a scanning tool into a software development architecture. For instance, the plugin component can be installed in any of the cloud development platforms mentioned herein.

(103) Act **2510** then includes determining that an application, which is being hosted in the software development architecture, is entering a development state in which a code build of the application is to occur. For instance, the scanning tool mentioned throughout this disclosure can operate with the system's OS or cloud services to determine when the application is to be built. In some cases, a library or SDK triggers the scanning tool when the application enters the build process. The configuration settings and user interfaces mentioned earlier can also be used to determine when the application is to be built. That is, as a result of configuring the scanning tool using the disclosed user interfaces, the scanning tool is afforded privileges into how the application operates and can thus identify when a code build is to occur.

(104) After the code build for the application has started, act **2515** includes preventing the code build from completing. The process of preventing the code build from completing can be performed by delaying the code build in some manner, such as by injecting a delay into the code build or by preventing a particular task from completing.

(105) While the code build is being prevented from completing, act **2520** includes causing the scanning tool to perform a penetrative test of the application. The scanning tool can be configured using the techniques described earlier. Furthermore, in some cases, the scanning tool is provided read-only access to the application hosted in the software development architecture. In some cases, the scanning tool performs a new penetrative test each time a new code build of the application is attempted. During a first instance when a new application is being developed, the scanning tool can perform a complete scan on the application. During later or subsequent scans, the scanning tool can scan only changes or deltas that have transpired since the last time the application was scanned. To identify such changes, the current version of the code can be compared against an earlier, archived version.

(106) The penetrative test exercises the application in an attempt to identify vulnerabilities. For instance, the penetrative test can include an analysis of source code of the application, an analysis of the software development architecture, or even an analysis of security features associated with the application.

(107) The scanning tool identifies, or rather generates, results of the penetrative test. For instance, one result of the penetrative test can include a listing of identified vulnerabilities that have been identified for the application. In some cases, the vulnerabilities included in the listing are ranked according to severity.

(108) In some cases, the Red Teaming organization or group can attempt to identify techniques

that, if followed, might resolve those vulnerabilities. In some embodiments, the penetrative test includes a determination as to whether the application complies with one or more preselected regulations, such as HIPPA, PCI, and so forth. In some cases, the regulations can be internally generated regulations, such as best coding practices. Here, the scanning tool can determine whether the coding structure complies with an enterprises established coding guidelines or principles.

(109) In some implementations, the scanning tool includes a user interface having a particular visual layout. For instance, the visual layout can include a security status dashboard, such as that shown in FIGS. **20** and **21**. Optionally, the dashboard can include an element for indicating a number of vulnerabilities that have been identified for the application. The dashboard can also include an element indicating a number of failed code builds that have occurred for the application. In some cases, the dashboard can include an element indicating a number of vulnerabilities that have been identified for the software development architecture. In some cases, the user interface or dashboard can further display a description for each vulnerability that has been identified for the application as a result of performing the penetrative test.

(110) Based on a result of the penetrative test, act **2525** includes either permitting the code build to complete or, alternatively, terminating the code build prior to completion. If the number of vulnerabilities does not exceed a predetermined threshold number and/or if the number of critical issues or vulnerabilities does not exceed a particular threshold, then the scanning tool can permit the code build to complete. On the other hand, if the number of vulnerabilities and/or critical issues does exceed particular thresholds, then the scanning tool can prevent the code build from completing, such as by throwing an error or terminating a task.

(111) Act **2530** involves generating an alert that includes the result of the penetrative test. The alert can be displayed in the user interfaces mentioned earlier, such as those described in FIGS. **20** and **21**.

(112) FIG. **26** shows another flowchart of an example method **2600** for again dynamically controlling whether a code build of an application finishes to completion or is terminated prior to completion. Initially, method **2600** includes an act (act **2605**) of identifying that a scanning tool is operating as a plugin component in a software development architecture. This identification process can be performed by identifying the launch of the scanning tool, such as perhaps via an OS communication.

(113) Act **2610** includes determining that an application, which is being hosted in the software development architecture, is entering a development state where a code build of the application executes to generate executable code for the application. After the code build for the application has started, act **2615** involves preventing the code build from completing generation of the executable code for the application at least until after a penetrative test of the application is performed by the scanning tool. In some cases, the scanning tool includes machine learning that facilitates the penetrative test and/or a review of the results of the penetrative test. Some embodiments cause the scanning tool to consult a public database to determine whether the application is subject to known threats that are included in the public database.

(114) The application includes source code stored in a central repository. In some cases, the scanning tool performs the penetrative test on only source code that is checked-in at the central repository, which can be managed by the software development architecture.

(115) While the code build is being prevented from completing the generation of the executable code for the application, act **2620** includes causing the scanning tool to perform the penetrative test of the application. Based on a result of the penetrative test, act **2625** includes either permitting the code build to complete the generation of the executable code or, alternatively, terminating the code build prior to completing the generation of the executable code.

(116) In some cases, the code build is permitted to complete the generation of the executable code. As a consequence, the executable code is deployed and executed such that the application can then execute. Optionally, the scanning tool can be configured to identify when an attack is occurring

against the executing application.

(117) Accordingly, the disclosed embodiments beneficially introduce a scanning tool into the development pipeline. The scanning tool is at least triggered during a code build process included as a part of the development pipeline. The scanning tool is configured to delay the code build process for a period of time to enable a penetration test (performed by the scanning tool) to be performed. Based on the results of the test, the scanning tool can either allow the code build to complete or, alternatively, terminate the code build. If the termination occurs, then the scanning tool determined the application was too susceptible to misuse and exploitation. Therefore, the disclosed embodiments significantly improve computer security by ensuring that applications are sufficiently safe before being deployed or released to the public.

Example Computer/Computer Systems

(118) Attention will now be directed to FIG. 27 which illustrates an example computer system **2700** that may include and/or be used to perform any of the operations described herein. Computer system **2700** may take various different forms. For example, computer system **2700** may be embodied as a tablet **2700A**, a desktop or a laptop **2700B**, a wearable device **2700C**, a mobile device, or any other type of standalone device, as generally represented by the ellipsis **2700D**. Computer system **2700** may also be a distributed system that includes one or more connected computing components/devices that are in communication with computer system **2700**.

(119) In its most basic configuration, computer system **2700** includes various different components. FIG. 27 shows that computer system **2700** includes one or more processor(s) **2705** (aka a “hardware processing unit”) and storage **2710**.

(120) Regarding the processor(s) **2705**, it will be appreciated that the functionality described herein can be performed, at least in part, by one or more hardware logic components (e.g., the processor(s) **2705**). For example, and without limitation, illustrative types of hardware logic components/processors that can be used include Field-Programmable Gate Arrays (“FPGA”), Program-Specific or Application-Specific Integrated Circuits (“ASIC”), Program-Specific Standard Products (“ASSP”), System-On-A-Chip Systems (“SOC”), Complex Programmable Logic Devices (“CPLD”), Central Processing Units (“CPU”), Graphical Processing Units (“GPU”), or any other type of programmable hardware.

(121) As used herein, the terms “executable module,” “executable component,” “component,” “module,” “engine,” or “machine learning” can refer to hardware processing units or to software objects, routines, or methods that may be executed on computer system **2700**. The different components, modules, engines, and services described herein may be implemented as objects or processors that execute on computer system **2700** (e.g. as separate threads).

(122) Storage **2710** may be physical system memory, which may be volatile, non-volatile, or some combination of the two. The term “memory” may also be used herein to refer to non-volatile mass storage such as physical storage media. If computer system **2700** is distributed, the processing, memory, and/or storage capability may be distributed as well.

(123) Storage **2710** is shown as including executable instructions **2715**. The executable instructions **2715** represent instructions that are executable by the processor(s) **2705** of computer system **2700** to perform the disclosed operations, such as those described in the various methods.

(124) The disclosed embodiments may comprise or utilize a special-purpose or general-purpose computer including computer hardware, such as, for example, one or more processors (such as processor(s) **2705**) and system memory (such as storage **2710**), as discussed in greater detail below. Embodiments also include physical and other computer-readable media for carrying or storing computer-executable instructions and/or data structures. Such computer-readable media can be any available media that can be accessed by a general-purpose or special-purpose computer system. Computer-readable media that store computer-executable instructions in the form of data are “physical computer storage media” or a “hardware storage device.” Computer-readable media that carry computer-executable instructions are “transmission media.” Thus, by way of example and not

limitation, the current embodiments can comprise at least two distinctly different kinds of computer-readable media: computer storage media and transmission media.

(125) Computer storage media (aka “hardware storage device”) are computer-readable hardware storage devices, such as RANI, ROM, EEPROM, CD-ROM, solid state drives (“SSD”) that are based on RANI, Flash memory, phase-change memory (“PCM”), or other types of memory, or other optical disk storage, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium that can be used to store desired program code means in the form of computer-executable instructions, data, or data structures and that can be accessed by a general-purpose or special-purpose computer.

(126) Computer system **2700** may also be connected (via a wired or wireless connection) to external sensors (e.g., one or more remote cameras) or devices via a network **2720**. For example, computer system **2700** can communicate with any number devices or cloud services to obtain or process data. In some cases, network **2720** may itself be a cloud network. Furthermore, computer system **2700** may also be connected through one or more wired or wireless networks **2720** to remote/separate computer systems(s) that are configured to perform any of the processing described with regard to computer system **2700**.

(127) A “network,” like network **2720**, is defined as one or more data links and/or data switches that enable the transport of electronic data between computer systems, modules, and/or other electronic devices. When information is transferred, or provided, over a network (either hardwired, wireless, or a combination of hardwired and wireless) to a computer, the computer properly views the connection as a transmission medium. Computer system **2700** will include one or more communication channels that are used to communicate with the network **2720**. Transmissions media include a network that can be used to carry data or desired program code means in the form of computer-executable instructions or in the form of data structures. Further, these computer-executable instructions can be accessed by a general-purpose or special-purpose computer. Combinations of the above should also be included within the scope of computer-readable media.

(128) Upon reaching various computer system components, program code means in the form of computer-executable instructions or data structures can be transferred automatically from transmission media to computer storage media (or vice versa). For example, computer-executable instructions or data structures received over a network or data link can be buffered in RAM within a network interface module (e.g., a network interface card or “NIC”) and then eventually transferred to computer system RANI and/or to less volatile computer storage media at a computer system. Thus, it should be understood that computer storage media can be included in computer system components that also (or even primarily) utilize transmission media.

(129) Computer-executable (or computer-interpretable) instructions comprise, for example, instructions that cause a general-purpose computer, special-purpose computer, or special-purpose processing device to perform a certain function or group of functions. The computer-executable instructions may be, for example, binaries, intermediate format instructions such as assembly language, or even source code. Although the subject matter has been described in language specific to structural features and/or methodological acts, it is to be understood that the subject matter defined in the appended claims is not necessarily limited to the described features or acts described above. Rather, the described features and acts are disclosed as example forms of implementing the claims.

(130) Those skilled in the art will appreciate that the embodiments may be practiced in network computing environments with many types of computer system configurations, including personal computers, desktop computers, laptop computers, message processors, hand-held devices, multi-processor systems, microprocessor-based or programmable consumer electronics, network PCs, minicomputers, mainframe computers, mobile telephones, PDAs, pagers, routers, switches, and the like. The embodiments may also be practiced in distributed system environments where local and remote computer systems that are linked (either by hardwired data links, wireless data links, or by a

combination of hardwired and wireless data links) through a network each perform tasks (e.g. cloud computing, cloud services and the like). In a distributed system environment, program modules may be located in both local and remote memory storage devices.

(131) The present invention may be embodied in other specific forms without departing from its characteristics. The described embodiments are to be considered in all respects only as illustrative and not restrictive. The scope of the invention is, therefore, indicated by the appended claims rather than by the foregoing description. All changes which come within the meaning and range of equivalency of the claims are to be embraced within their scope.

Claims

1. A method for dynamically controlling whether a code build of an application finishes to completion or is terminated prior to completion, said method comprising: installing, as a plugin component, a scanning tool into a software development architecture; determining that an application, which is being hosted in the software development architecture, is transitioning from a first state to a code building state in which a code build of the application is to occur, wherein determining that the application is transitioning from the first state to the code building state includes at least one of: causing the scanning tool to interact with an operating system of a computer hosting the application to determine that the application is transitioning from the first state to the code building state, or, alternatively, causing the scanning tool to intercept an inter-application communication and using the intercepted inter-application communication to determine that the application is transitioning from the first state to the code building state; after the code build for the application has started, causing the scanning tool to prevent the code build from completing; while the scanning tool is preventing the code build from completing, causing the scanning tool to perform a penetrative test of the application to detect vulnerabilities, wherein the scanning tool further causes the penetrative test to additionally scan the software development architecture that is hosting the application such that both the application and the software development architecture are subjected to the penetrative test during a time when the scanning tool is preventing the code build from completing; while the scanning tool is preventing the code build from completing and in response to a detected vulnerability detected relative to the application, triggering attempted mitigation of the detected vulnerability, wherein mitigating the vulnerability comprises at least one of: closing a port, establishing a firewall, or alternatively, terminating a network connection; based on a result of the penetrative test, either permitting the code build to complete or, alternatively, terminating the code build prior to completion; and generating an alert that includes the result of the penetrative test.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the penetrative test includes an analysis of security features associated with the application and a listing of the detected vulnerability in the application.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein the scanning tool has read-only access to the application hosted in the software development architecture.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein the scanning tool performs a new penetrative test each time a new code build of the application is attempted.
5. The method of claim 1, wherein preventing the code build from completing includes injecting a delay command into a process of the code build.
6. The method of claim 1, wherein the scanning tool is caused to intercept the inter-application communication, and wherein the intercepted inter-application communication is used to determine that the application is transitioning from the first state to the code building state.
7. The method of claim 1, wherein: the scanning tool is configured to detect whether the application, after the code build is permitted to complete, is subject to a slow attack, which is a type of attack in which a relatively small stream of traffic targets the application, and detecting that the application is subject to the slow attack includes the scanning tool analyzing a fingerprint of a data

packet sent to the application.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein mitigating the detected vulnerability comprises closing the port.

9. The method of claim 8, wherein mitigating the detected vulnerability further comprises establishing the firewall in addition to closing the port.

10. The method of claim 9, wherein mitigating the detected vulnerability further comprises terminating the network connection in addition to closing the port and establishing the firewall.

11. A computer system configured to dynamically control whether a code build of an application finishes to completion or is terminated prior to completion, said computer system comprising: one or more processors; and one or more computer-readable hardware storage devices that store instructions that are executable by the one or more processors to cause the computer system to: identify that a scanning tool is operating as a plugin component in a software development architecture; determine that an application, which is being hosted in the software development architecture, is entering a development state where a code build of the application executes to generate executable code for the application; after the code build for the application has started, cause the scanning tool to prevent the code build from completing generation of the executable code for the application at least until after a penetrative test of the application is performed by the scanning tool, wherein preventing the code build from completing generation of the executable code includes injecting a delay command into a process of the code build; while the scanning tool is preventing the code build from completing the generation of the executable code via use of the injected delay command, cause the scanning tool to perform the penetrative test of the application, wherein the scanning tool further causes the penetrative test to additionally scan the software development architecture that is hosting the application such that both the application and the software development architecture are subjected to the penetrative test during a time when the scanning tool is preventing the code build from completing; while the scanning tool is preventing the code build from completing and based on a vulnerability detected from the penetrative test, employ a mitigation technique in response to the vulnerability, wherein the mitigation technique comprises at least one of: closing a port, establishing a firewall, or alternatively, terminating a network connection; and based on a result of the mitigation technique, either permit the code build to complete the generation of the executable code or, alternatively, terminate the code build prior to completing the generation of the executable code.

12. The computer system of claim 11, wherein the penetrative test includes a determination as to whether the application complies with one or more preselected regulations.

13. The computer system of claim 11, wherein the scanning tool includes a user interface having a particular visual layout, and wherein the visual layout includes a security status dashboard comprising: an element indicating a number of vulnerabilities that have been identified for the application; an element indicating a number of failed code builds that have occurred for the application; an element indicating a number of vulnerabilities that have been identified for the software development architecture.

14. The computer system of claim 13, wherein the user interface further displays a description for each vulnerability that has been identified for the application as a result of performing the penetrative test.

15. The computer system of claim 11, wherein the code build is permitted to complete the generation of the executable code, wherein the executable code is deployed and executed such that the application is executing, and wherein the scanning tool identifies when an attack is occurring against the executing application.

16. The computer system of claim 11, wherein the scanning tool includes machine learning that facilitates the penetrative test.

17. The computer system of claim 11, wherein the scanning tool consults a public database to determine whether the application is subject to known threats that are included in the public database.

18. The computer system of claim 11, wherein the application includes source code, and wherein the scanning tool performs the penetrative test on only source code that is checked-in at a central repository, which is managed by the software development architecture.

19. A method for dynamically controlling whether a code build of an application finishes to completion or is terminated prior to completion, said method comprising: determining that an application, which is being hosted in a software development architecture, is entering a development state in which a code build of the application is to occur; after the code build for the application has started, using a scanning tool installed as a plugin component in the software development architecture to prevent the code build from finishing a set of build tasks; while the scanning tool is preventing the code build from finishing the set of build tasks, causing the scanning tool to perform a penetrative test of the application, wherein the scanning tool further causes the penetrative test to additionally scan the software development architecture that is hosting the application such that both the application and the software development architecture are subjected to the penetrative test during a time when the scanning tool is preventing the code build from completing; while the scanning tool is preventing the code build from finishing the set of build tasks, mitigating a detected vulnerability associated with the application, wherein mitigating the detected vulnerability comprises at least one of: closing a port, establishing a firewall, or alternatively, terminating a network connection; and based on a result of the penetrative test, terminating the code build prior to the set of build tasks finishing, wherein the result of the penetrative test indicates that the scanning tool has identified at least a threshold number of vulnerabilities for the application and wherein terminating the code build includes throwing an error into a process of the code build.

20. The method of claim 19, wherein the set of build tasks includes pushing an update to a client device, and wherein the code build is terminated prior to pushing the update.
